



THE PATTERNS OF ORGANIZATION

Organization

What are patterns of organization?

- Details support a main or implied main idea
- Authors often organize supporting details in a particular order...thus creating a pattern
- Patterns are how the groups of supporting details are organized
- Recognizing the patterns, of the organization of the supporting details, will help
 - *understand how an author thinks*
 - *logically order the information*
 - *begin predicting test questions*

Types of Organizational Patterns

- Chronological
- Definition and Example
- Classification
- Cause and Effect
- Comparison and Contrast
- Process

Chronological order is...

- also known as time order, or sequence of events.
- ideas are presented in the order in which they occur or take place in time.
- Questions Answered:
 - *“When did it happen?”*
 - *“In what order did it happen?”*
- When Used:
 - *Commonly used in history and narratives.*

Definition and Example

- found primarily in textbooks
- a word or concept is explained or described. An example of its use then follows.
- The pattern is very close to Illustration or description
- Important words or phrases are also defined in the glossary.

Definition and Example

- Readings answer the question: “What is it?”
- key term (often boldfaced, underlined or in italics)
- definition
- example
- Ragtime music is a style that developed at the turn of the twentieth century
 - *TERM*
 - Class Distinguishing
 - Characteristics
 - *Examples*
 - *RAGTIME*
 - piano jazz
 - syncopated rhythm
 - *ex. Rocking Horse Rag*

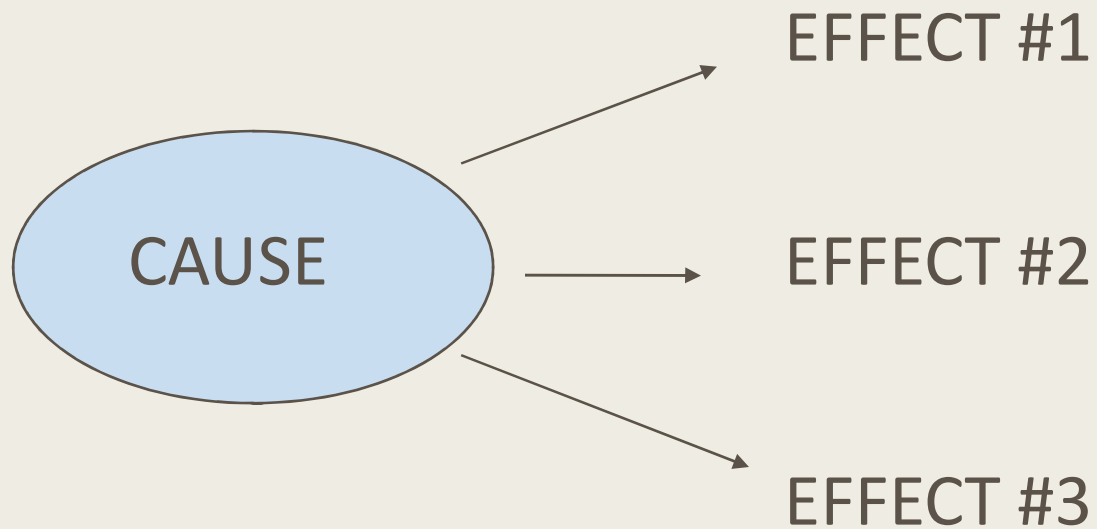
Cause and Effect

- Describes or discusses an event or action that is caused by another event or action. On occasion, this pattern is also referred to as **result**.

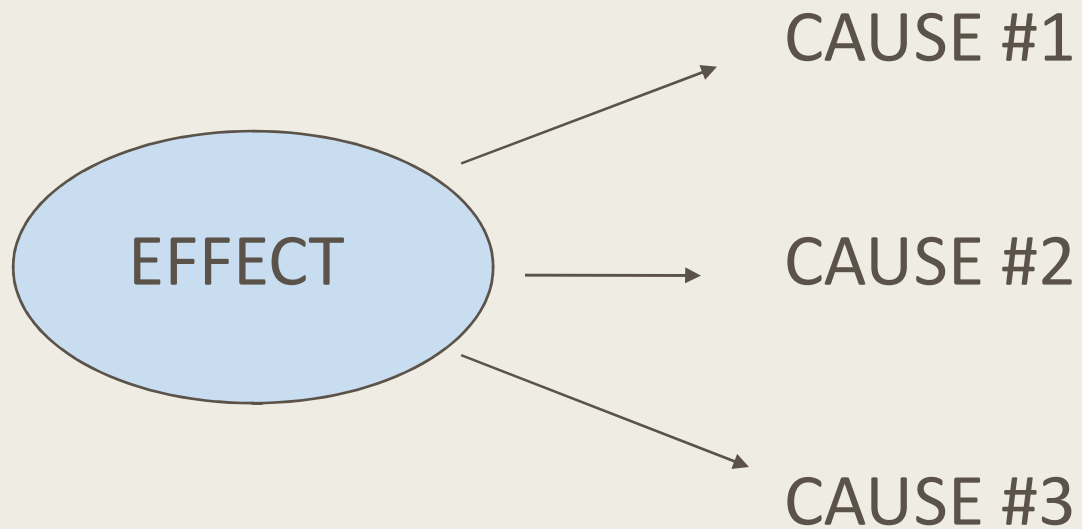
- **cause-effect relationships**
 - *single cause - single effect*
 - *single cause - multiple effects*
 - *multiple causes - single effect*
 - *multiple causes - multiple effects*

- Readings answer the questions:
 - “*Why did something happen?*”
 - “*What were the results of a particular event?*”

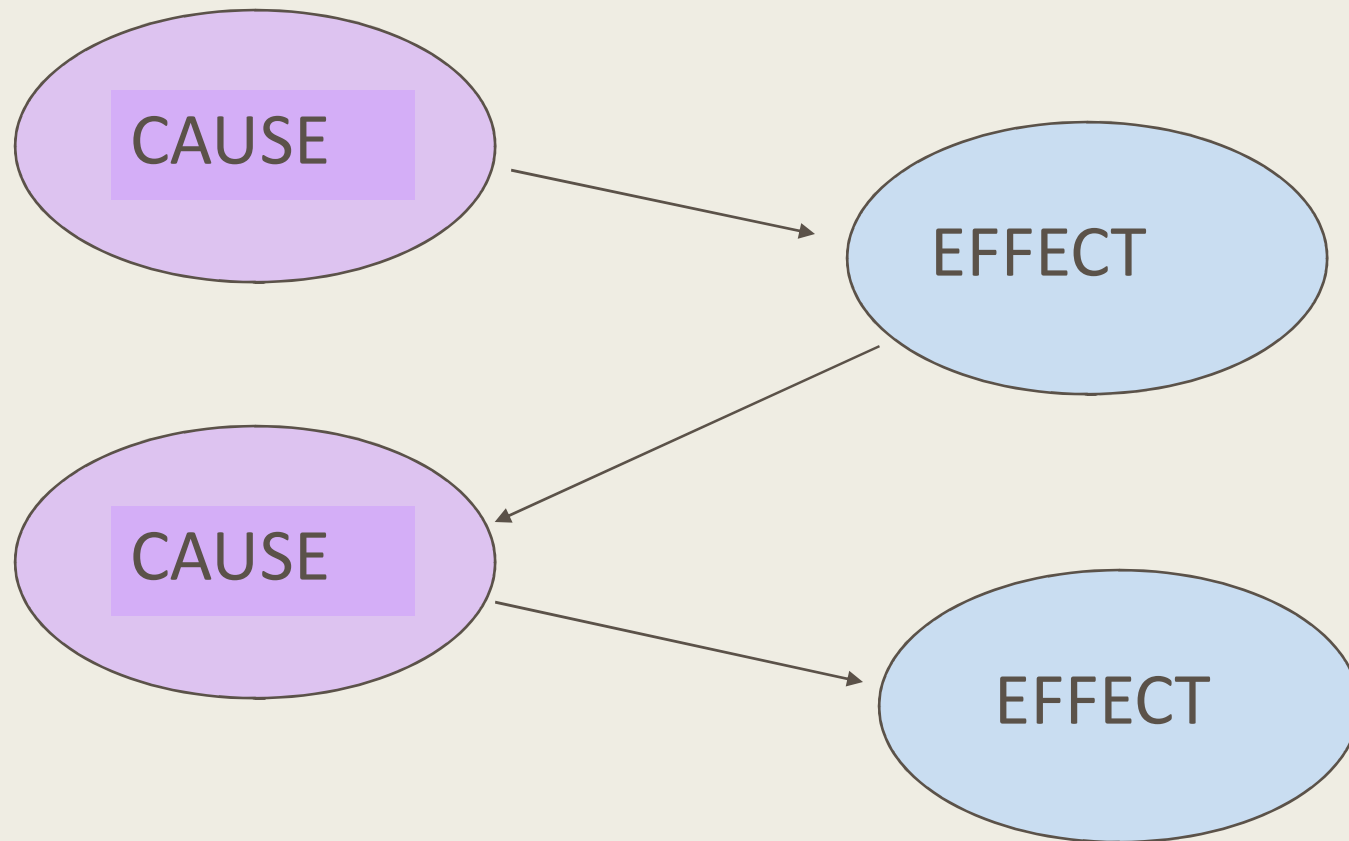
Focus on Effects



Focus on Causes



Cause and Effect Chain



Classification

- Classification, also known as **division** or **categorization**, divides a topic into parts that are based on shared or common characteristics.
- Readings answer the questions:
 - *“How do the parts work with the whole?”*
 - *Ex: What part does an editor play in the publication of a magazine?*
- Thesis: There are many people involved in the publishing of a magazine.

Comparison and Contrast

- Text is organized to show relationship between two objects
- emphasizes the similarities and/or differences between two or more items or topics..
- Results in a meaningful analysis of what these differences and similarities mean
- comparison means
 - *what things have in common*
 - *how items or concepts are alike*
 - *the similarities between elements or ideas*
- contrast means
 - *the differences between items or concepts*
 - *how things are not alike*
 - *distinctions between elements*
- Readings answer the questions:
 - “How are these similar?”
 - “How are these different?”
- Thesis: Gangs and fraternities share many characteristics, but are quite different.

Process

- The information explains the steps in a particular procedure or process.
- The steps and stages lead up to a final product or finished project.
- Answers the questions:
 - *“How does x become y?”*
 - *“In what sequence?”*
- In order to drive a car, everyone must follow the steps which the state requires for a license.

Practice:

Identify the main pattern of organization

- a. definition and example
- b. cause and effect
- c. comparison-contrast
- d. chronological
- e. process

1. A boycott is an organized refusal by people to deal with a person or group in order to reach a certain goal. An example is the famous boycott that began in 1955 when Mrs. Parks of Montgomery, Alabama, refused to obey a law requiring black people to sit at the back of city buses. Mrs. Parks was arrested, and her arrest sparked a boycott of the city bus system by African Americans. The boycott was organized and led by Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr. Rather than continue to lose money needed to run the bus system, the city changed the law.

- *The main pattern of organization is:*
- *Transitions that signal the pattern:*

a. definition and example
transition: is, an example

Practice:

Identify the main pattern of organization

- a. definition and example
- b. cause and effect
- c. comparison-contrast
- d. chronological
- e. process

- The story of the city mouse and the country mouse is one version of the age-old debate between the people who prefer city life and those who prefer country life. In the city there is always something to do. But in the country, you can always find peace and quiet. In the city, you are constantly exposed to new and different kinds of people. On the other hand, in the country, you are always among familiar faces. These are the images we have. The reality is less clear-cut. Rural towns do have their night spots, and even New York City has places to escape to and be alone with your thoughts.
 - *The main pattern of organization is:*
 - *Transitions that signal the pattern:*

C : comparison-contrast

transition: but / On the other hand

Practice:

Identify the main pattern of organization

- a. definition and example
- b. cause and effect
- c. comparison-contrast
- d. chronological
- e. process

- Many people say rapid population growth is the reason why nearly one billion people go hungry every day. However, political factors are also among the causes of hunger. First, many countries with hungry citizens actually export crops to other countries. Exporting the crops offers greater profits than selling them at home. Secondly, surpluses that could feed many people are often destroyed in order to keep the price of products high. For example, some crops are allowed to rot, and extra milk is fed to pigs or even dumped.

- *The main pattern of organization is:*
- *Transitions that signal the pattern:*

B: cause and effect

transition: causes / in order to